

R² recovery ladder for each stage-pair

Layer 30, raw pooled R². Mean of held-out R² across 8 corpora $\pm$ across-corpus 1 σ band. Post-SFT pairs (SFT $\rightarrow$ DPO, DPO $\rightarrow$ RLVR, DPO $\rightarrow$ longer-RLVR) recover at t0 or t5; base $\rightarrow$ <stage> pairs stay low at every tier.

